

Every AI initiative, from idea to measured value.

Build Lab is our operating system for AI across the portfolio — one place where ideas come in, get scored consistently, get decided by people, get built fast, and get measured honestly.

A short tour for new users · August 2026 · [build-lab.dev](#)

Data informs. Scoring creates consistency. Humans decide.

Submit → Triage → Score → Rank → Governance → Build → Measure

One pipeline, five stages.

Every AI idea — from a portfolio company workflow to one of our own internal processes — moves through the same pipeline. Nothing gets built on a whim, and nothing good gets lost in an inbox. The system keeps a permanent record of what we decided, why, and what it returned.

01

Submit

Anyone submits an idea in 5–7 minutes. No login needed.

02

Score

The triage team scores every idea against the same five-part rubric.

03

Decide

Governance reviews the ranked portfolio and decides what we pursue. Always people, never the algorithm.

04

Build

Approved work becomes a project with phases, owners, and a target date.

05

Measure

Every project keeps its success metrics — estimates never masquerade as results.

Scoring weighs the opportunity itself (impact, speed to something usable, data feasibility, sponsorship, repeatability) and — for portfolio company ideas — **where we have the most capital at work and the longest runway**. A great idea at a company we just backed outranks the same idea at one nearing exit.

Three things to try on your first visit

- 1 Submit an idea** — go to build-lab.dev/submit and put in a real opportunity you've been thinking about. It takes 5 minutes and autosaves as you go. (Page 3)
- 2 Open a live project** — sign in, open **Projects**, and click into one. You'll see exactly where it stands, what's next, and what's blocked — without asking anyone. (Page 4)
- 3 Scan the portfolio** — open **Analytics** for the whole picture: what's coming in, what we approved, how fast things move, and what's actually been measured. (Page 5)

The intake form: five minutes, no login.

Anyone — our team or portfolio company leadership — can submit at build-lab.dev/submit. The form branches based on the type of request, saves automatically as you type, and never asks a question that doesn't matter for that request. "Unknown" is always an acceptable answer — don't let a missing detail stop a good idea.

Submit an AI Initiative
Takes about 5-7 minutes if you know the opportunity well. Your answers save automatically — keep this page's link if you want to finish later.

What kind of request is this?

Specialist — Specialist Build
An Internal Specialist requests an AI capability for a Specialist workflow.

Specialist — Portfolio Company Build
An Internal Specialist submits or sponsors an AI opportunity involving a portfolio company.

Generalist — Portfolio Company Build
An Internal Generalist submits or sponsors an AI opportunity involving a portfolio company.

STEP 1 · BASICS

Who you are, a name for the idea, and — for portfolio company requests — **which company, which function, and who's sponsoring it** internally.

STEP 3 · THE ASK

What you actually want AI to do — the task, not "use AI" — plus **what success looks like 90 days after launch** and any metrics that exist today.

STEP 5 · PRIORITY SIGNAL

If you could fund only one AI initiative this quarter, is this it? Any deadline or forcing event, and **who owns the business outcome**.

Step 3 of 6
The Ask

What do you want AI to actually do?
Describe the task itself, not just "use AI". Example: "Create first-pass QBR decks using CRM, customer usage, and support data."

What would success look like 90 days after this ships?

What metrics exist today?
Add metric: ☐ No meaningful baseline exists today

What value does this create?
☐ Revenue ☐ Cost ☐ Margin
☐ Productivity ☐ Customer Experience ☐ Quality
☐ Risk ☐ Speed ☐ Strategic Capability
☐ Other

How, specifically?

Requester effort estimate
Your rough sense — triage will make the final call.
☐ Small: Days of work — a focused tool or automation touching one workflow.
☐ Medium: Weeks of work — a tool or automation touching multiple workflows.
☐ Large: Months of work — a new system or process.

STEP 2 · BUSINESS PROBLEM

What process or challenge you want to address, **how it works today** (who does it, what tools, how often, how long), and who or what is affected.

STEP 4 · FEASIBILITY

What data and systems are involved, whether anyone has tried before, and your honest guess at **how fast something usable could exist**.

STEP 6 · REVIEW & SUBMIT

One screen showing everything, with edit shortcuts. After submitting, the link becomes a **status page** you can check anytime.

Projects: what we're building, at a glance.

When governance approves an initiative, it becomes a project with a lead, a target date, and a ten-phase path from Discovery to Complete. The overview answers the questions you'd normally have to ask in a meeting — and the red stripe means the same thing on every project.

The screenshot displays the BCP Build Lab interface. On the left is a dark blue sidebar with a navigation menu. The main content area shows a project overview for 'FP&A variance narrative drafts'. At the top, there's a search bar and user links (Notifications, Alex Admin, Sign out). Below the project title, key details are listed: Company (Cobalt Health Partners), Function (Finance), Lane (Rapid Deployment), Lead (Sofia Rossi), Business owner (Dana Wu), and Target deployment (Sep 5, 2026). A phase rail shows the project's progress through ten phases: Discovery, Solution Design, Data / Access, Build, QA, User Testing (current), Pilot, Production, Measurement, and Complete. Below the phase rail, there are tabs for Overview, Tasks (3), Updates (1), KPIs, and Activity. The 'Outcome' section describes the goal: 'Draft variance narratives from GL exports and budget files for analyst review.' and a success metric: 'Narratives drafted within 4 hours of close; analysts edit rather than write.' Two boxes show 'CURRENT STATUS' (Narrative quality sign-off from two analysts on July data. Sofia Rossi · about 1 hour ago) and 'NEXT MILESTONE' (Dry run on August close — Aug 15, 2026). A 'Blockers' section highlights 'August close dry run — Waiting on Cobalt IT to whitelist the export service account.' The 'Recent activity' section shows three entries from Aug 13, 8:33 PM: 'Health GREEN → YELLOW: Dry run blocked on Cobalt IT service-account approval — 5 days waiting.', 'Phase → User Testing', and 'Project started'.

The phase rail shows exactly where it stands

Discovery → Build → Pilot → Production → Measurement — green is done, dark is now.

Blockers surface themselves

Anything stuck appears on the project, the delivery dashboard, and the home page — no chasing.

Health is honest by design

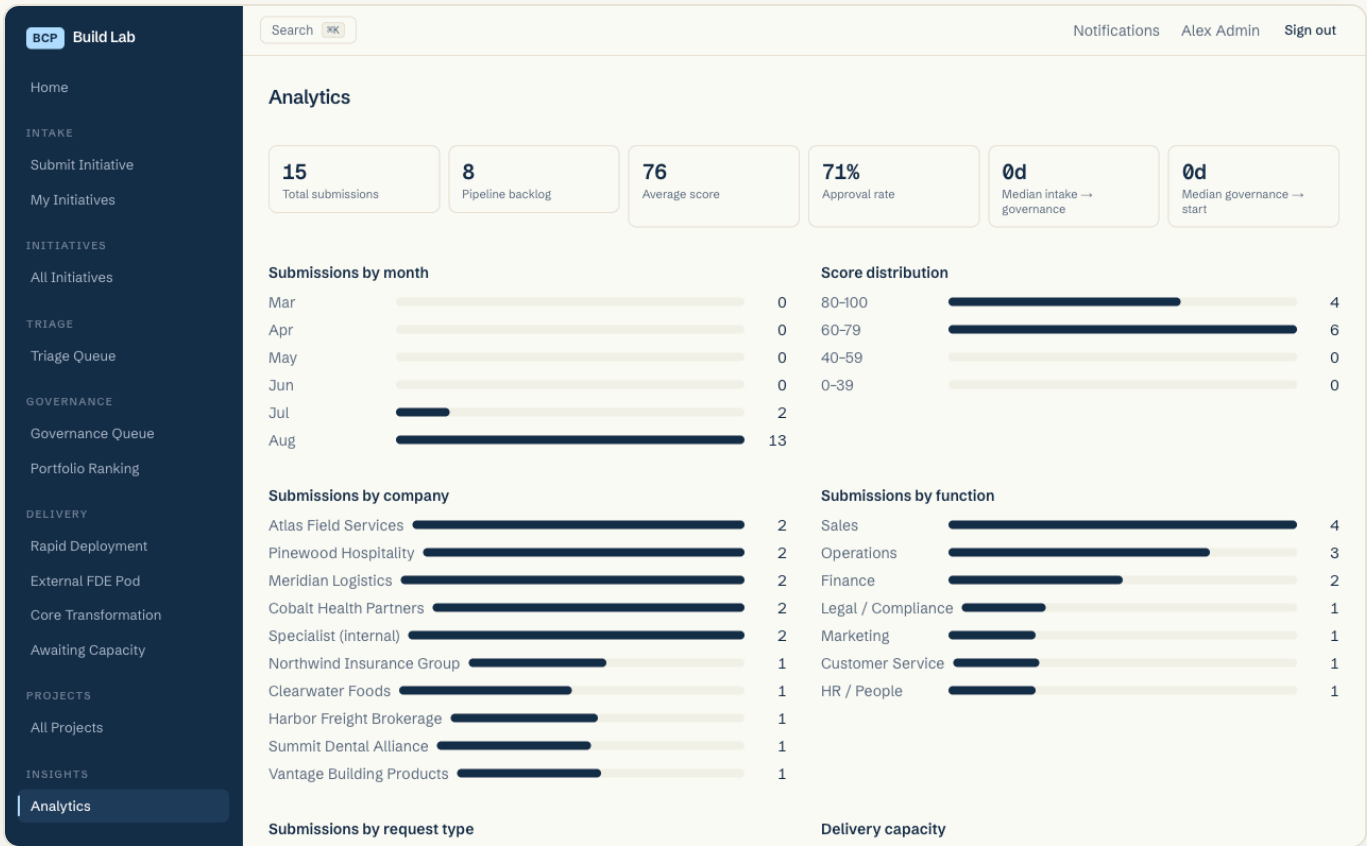
Green, yellow, or red — and yellow or red always comes with a written reason.

Every project keeps its "why"

One click back to the original initiative: the problem, the scores, and the governance decision that approved it.

Analytics: the whole portfolio on one page.

Where ideas come from, how they score, what governance approves, how fast things move from intake to build, and — most importantly — **validated value**: a results table that only admits measured outcomes, never projections. If it's in that table, it happened.



Getting started

Darren will send your sign-in credentials separately. Submitting an idea never requires an account — share the submit link freely.

build-lab.dev
build-lab.dev/submit